

LEARN CREATIVE TECHNIQUES



**MACHINE KNIT
WITH KNIT-1**

CREATIVE TECHNIQUES



Creative Techniques

This course includes:

- v 2 projects in 'ribbon work' for designer knitwear**
- v Woven silk fabric with knit wrap**
- v Nylon net with knit, futuristic bodice**
- v Chiffon with knit**
- v Random shapes knitted together for a contour bodice**
- v Precision knit fully fashion bodice in graphic style**

Step by step photo stories to show each piece as it is created, using standard gauge and chunky domestic single bed knit machine.

“It’s incredible how techniques are presented from a creative point of view” - Juan, Spain 2010.



Antique ribbon work

Inspiration

Antique textiles are the starting point for this knit technique. The idea of creating a piece of knit and then joining it to another piece of fabric in a decorative way.

The first piece we are going to create is a version of this ribbon work.

Project 1

Cardigan bodice front using floral motifs





Start by making the 'ribbon' which is 5 needles knitted approximately 2 meters long. This is used to follow the centre front line of a cardigan bodice.

To knit the heart shaped petals,

- **Cast on 4st**
- **Knit 2 r, then inc 2st ev r by transferring the edge st and then pulling an extra needle at the edge to knit**
- **When you have 16st knit 8r straight, no shaping**
- **Using the holding cams, hold half the sts and on the other side dec 1 st each side ev 2r for 4r**

- **Cast off. Then work the held side in the same way. Repeat to create 5 petals.**
- **Pin the shapes, purl side up onto the dummy as shown**



From the purl side, stitch the motifs together using this zig zag stitch, taking the needle behind the last stitch and then inserting into the edge diagonally opposite. This gives a really open and decorative join . (This stitch is known as faggoting)



Next, mark out the shape of the bodice that you want to create around the feature. We have done this using thick yarn to mark the outline on the dummy.



The plain knit bodice shape is pinned, purl side up, next to the ribbon work motifs. Then joined together in the same way using the open zig zag stitch. Complete all the finishing from the back and then turn the right side out.



Close up of hem detail



Close up of neckline detail

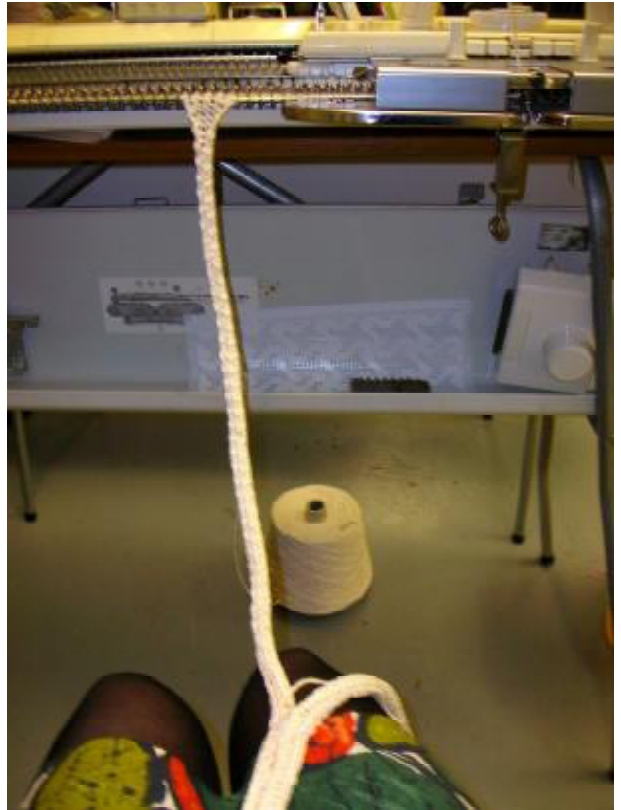


Project 2



This piece is made on the chunky machine using double knit cotton.

Start by casting on 10 needles and knit on a loose tension, knit 34cm (66 r). At this point split the pieces by carefully dropping half the sts and continue knitting on 5sts only for 40cm (82 r), cast off and hang the other 5sts back on the machine, repeat.

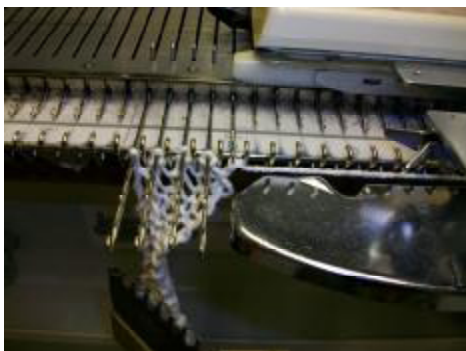


Pin the piece onto the dummy, purl side out.



From the purl side join the pieces in the same sewing stitch as you used for project 1.
 Next, you make the cross shape across the bust. Hang the fabric directly onto 10 needles and knit 15cm (30r), cast off, repeat for other side.





Cast on 5sts knit 11cm. Use the holding cams to hold 1st ev 2r until all sts are held, then push 1st ev 2r back into action until all needles are knitting again. This process will form a mitre in the piece.



Cancel the holding cams and continue knitting for 24cm (50 r), cast off. Make 1 pair.



Pin the pieces onto the dummy

Then you make the extra pieces for the side panels. This consists of 2 other long sections, 5sts by 26cm (54 r) and 2 shaped pieces, to make these, cast on 17 sts knit 4r then decrease both sides 1st ev r for 6 r and cast off. Repeat for 2nd piece.



Pin all the pieces onto the dummy and join as before.



Graphic bodice idea



**This piece is made on the standard gg
developing some of the same methods
as projects 1 and 2.
(2/16 lambs wool) tension 5.2**

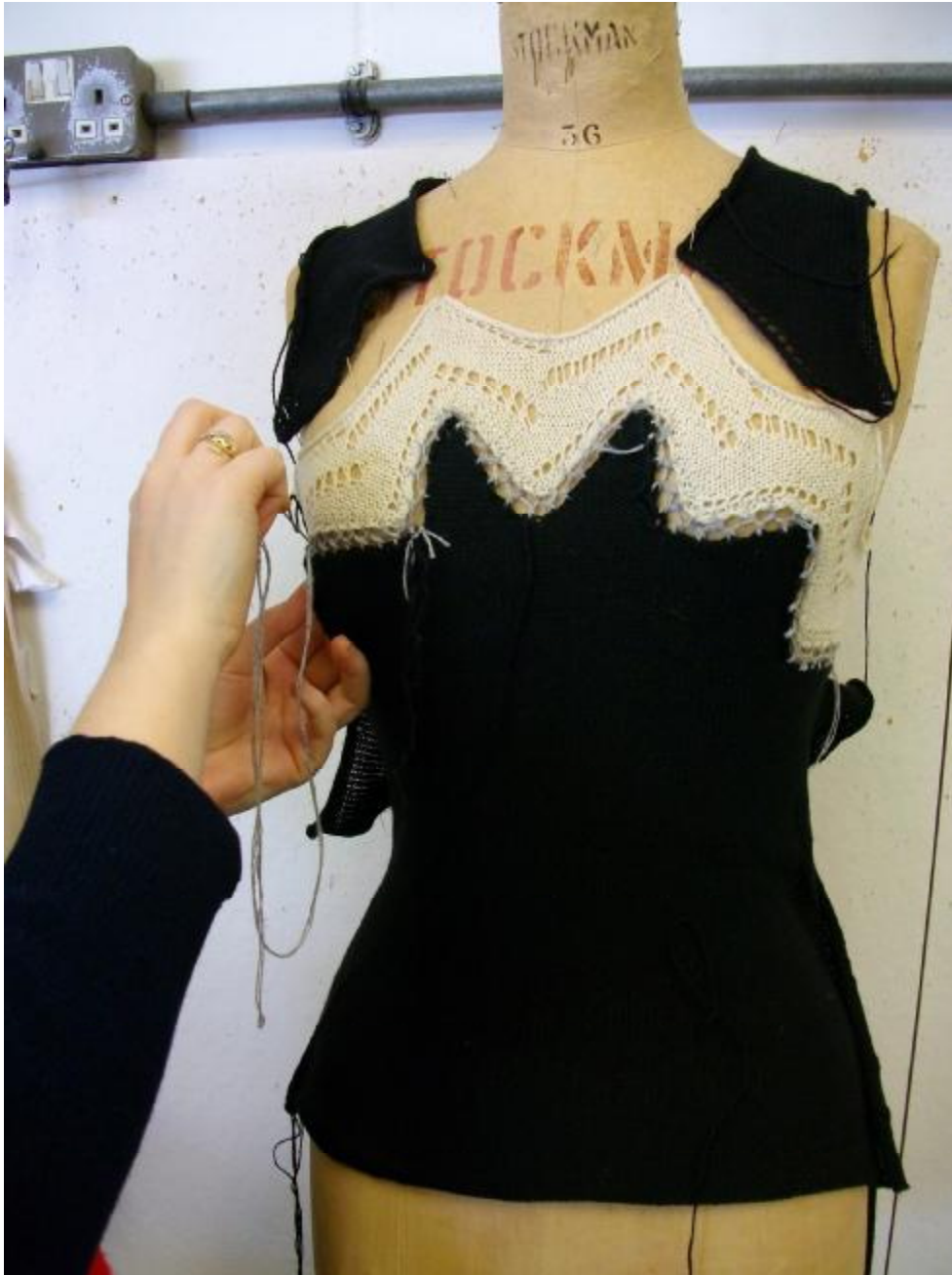


**Start by making the cream zig zag shape first.
Cast on 20sts, shape 1sts ev 2r, increasing at left side and decreasing at right side for 18r. We included a pointelle detail in the centre which follows the shape moving 1st ev 2 r.
At row 20 change direction and repeat. 10 repeats total.
Cast off.**





Next make the bodice shape. Cast on 130 sts knit 80r. cast off 30sts each side. Knit 25r, cast off 20 sts each side. Hold Half of the sts left (15), knit the other 15sts decreasing 1st ev 2 r at centre front until 6sts remain and cast off. Repeat for the other 15 sts.



The shoulder strap shape is made by casting on 15sts, increase 1 st ev 2 r on the right hand side for 30r. knit 40 r decreasing 1 st ev 4 r on the right hand side. Knit 10r no shaping and cast off. Repeat for the other strap but shape on the left side to create a pair.



Pin on to the dummy (purl side out) sew pieces together using the open stitch as before (we used a grey yarn to pick the stitching out against the knit sections). Once completed, turn right side out.



'Patchwork Technique'



This idea is great for starting with a random shaped piece and then growing the fabric in an organic way to fit the bodice shape you want.



We started with a triangle



Hang the shape back onto the machine using every other needle, knit 1 r then bring all needles into action, knit whatever shape you want and cast off.



Stage 1



Stage 2



There aren't any rules on this so just make it up as you along!





**This final piece was fitted
around the dummy and straps
were knitted on**



Pieced wrap





This technique uses a fabric with crochet edges and knit 'seams'. In this case we have used parachute silk and lambs wool. The resulting fabric is washed to soften and slightly felt the knit.



Start by cutting out the 'leaf' shapes from the silk fabric. You can make it any shape or size you want, we made ours approx 50cm x 2m for a generous size. Lay the pieces on a table so that you can see the size you will eventually make.

**Turn 1cm and press around each shape.
Using the lambs wool yarn, blanket stitch to hold down the edge on
each shape.**

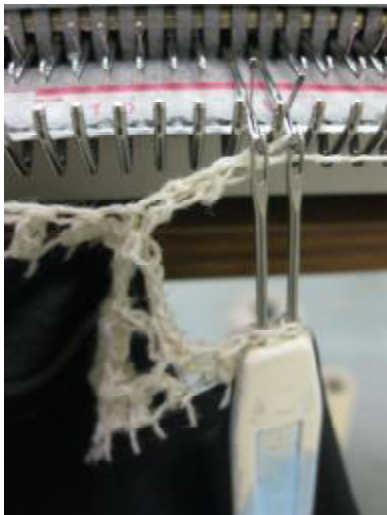


Use the stitched edge to make a band of simple treble crochet.



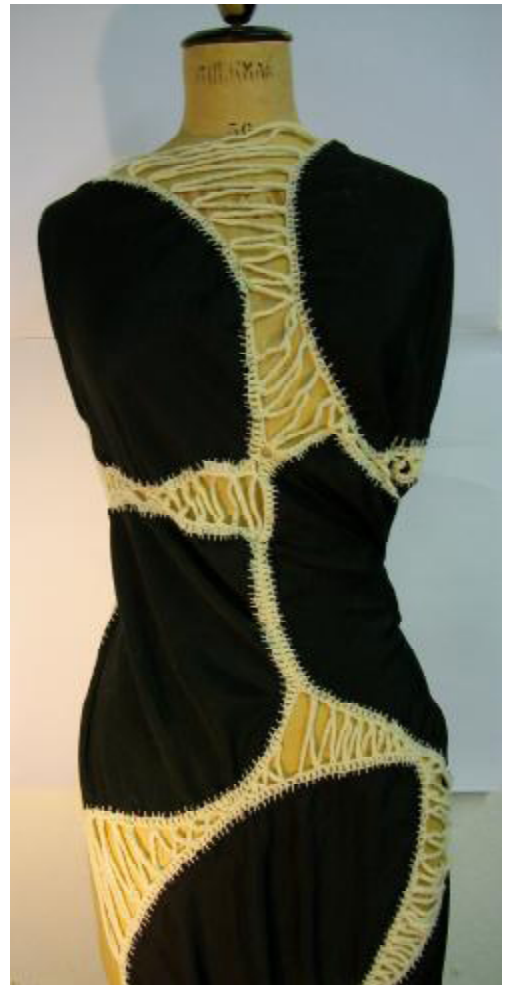


To start joining the shapes together, hang the edge onto 2 needles. Knit with no weight so that the 'chain' doesn't get stretched.



When you have a long enough chain to join to the next shape, pick up the edge of the next shape though the transfer tool, hook onto the needles and continue knitting to the next join. Keep repeating until you have filled the 'gaps' with chains going from side to side.





Nylon net with lambs wool knit seams





The first stage of this idea is to cut the fabric into a generous bodice shape and then to cut it into sections that will be joined together with knit areas.



To join 2 pieces of net together, cast on 12sts in the Lambswool, knit 2 r then hook the edge of the net as shown (allow approx 1cm from the net edge to allow for fraying) onto the 2 outside needles, knit 2 r then repeat the procedure, always keeping 12 needles total in action.

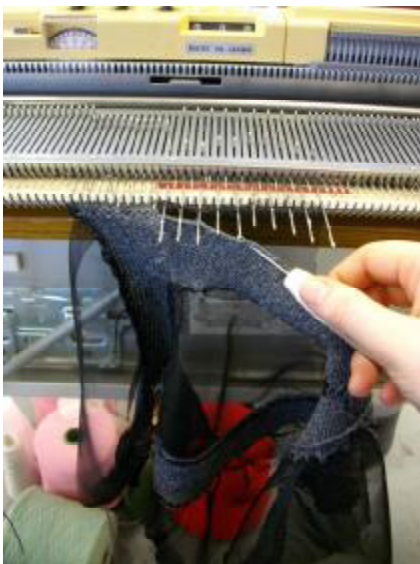
In this way gradually work your way around the 2 pieces of net to be joined.





Hang the neckline on across the net, knit the edge and cast off

When the piece is completed wash the fabric to slightly shrink the wool.



'Crazy' patchwork



This is a development of the previous technique but using a variety of fabrics and joining ideas.



Knit and chiffon



This item uses chiffon and cotton fabric areas joined with wool crochet and knit

This is a very simple idea that produces a gorgeous fabric. It combines silk chiffon with lambswool on the standard gg machine. The finished fabric is washed so the chiffon crinkles and the lambswool softens and slightly shrinks.

It is a great fabric for a luxury scarf or super soft sweater.



Start by cutting large strips of chiffon, approx. 15cm x 50cm.

**Turn back approx. 1cm along the edge of the fabric.
Using the transfer tool stab it through the chiffon to grab a needle.
Hang the long side of the chiffon directly onto the machine needles
using every other needle.**



Knit 1 r, then bring all the needles into action and continue knitting (approx 30r)





Hang the next section of chiffon onto the same needles, knit 1 very loose row and cast off. Then start the process again until all the chiffon is used.



Glossary

E-wrap	<i>cast on method for finished edge. Loop yarn around needles, behind the latches, from left to right, making the shape of an 'e' around each needle while the needles are in E position</i>
Sts	<i>stitches</i>
R	<i>rows</i>
Dec	<i>decrease</i>
Inc	<i>increase</i>
Holding cam	<i>control on Brother N or H, Knitmaster I or II. Select H or II for short row knitting. Needles in E position will not knit.</i>
Pointelle	<i>lace knit</i>
Shaping	<i>use the transfer tool to decrease or Increase the width of the piece</i>
Cast off	<i>bind off</i>
GG	<i>needle gauge (how many needles to 1")</i>



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